

MAY NEWSLETTER

9 MAY 2022



2022 COMMITTEE MEMBERS

Welcome again to our 2022 committee members. We encourage families to say hello and be familiar with the management team of our organisation. They will be driving the strategic direction of our service, advising on policy and budget decision making and organising other community events to support our families and those in the broader community.



Sue, Lauren, Chontelle, Clare, Trish & Eleanor. Absent from photo: Catherine Wiencke

MOTHER'S NIGHT OUT

Save the date for a fun night out with the mums, grandmothers & carers of the children who attend our service. Your invitation from the committee has been sent via the Xplor Home App and a copy is attached to this newsletter.

Date: Friday 20th May. RSVP by 17th May.

This is a great way to meet other ladies in our community, connect with your children's friends' families and reduce rural social isolation. We would love to see you all there.

BUILDING WORKS

The building work to the ceiling in the Dapin Room and their bathroom renovations are well on their way. The children in the Dapin Room are enjoying extra time in the outdoor learning environment and also time in the Gawul Room. We look forward to the completion of the works so we can return to a newly painted classroom and updated bathroom facilities.

SOON APPROACHING...

50 YEARS OF COMMUNITY PRE SCHOOL FOR GLOUCESTER CHILDREN

Our committee is starting to work on a plan to celebrate 50 years of preschool education in Gloucester. Our service was officially opened on 27th October 1972. With the land being donated to the community by the Gloucester Council and most of the building works donated free by the tradespeople of Gloucester. The service is a shining light of what can be achieved with a connected, engaged community.

If you have any information on the service's history, photos, names of teachers & committee members please share this with us to help with our planning. You can contact Robyn or email information to accounts@gloucesterpreschool.com.au

PLAYGROUP DATES

Booral...Tues 10 May
Gloucester CWA...Tues 17 May
Coolongolook...Wed 18 May
Booral...Tues 24 May
First Aid Course...Wed 25 May
Coolongolook...Wed 1 Jun
Gloucester CWA...Tues 7 Jun
Booral...Tues 14 Jun
Coolongolook...Wed 15 Jun
Gloucester CWA...Tues 21 Jun
Booral...Tues 28 Jun

DATES TO REMEMBER

- **Committee Meeting**
Tuesday 31st May, 6pm-8pm
at the Pre School

EQUIPMENT PURCHASES

Felt mobile animals to hang over the change tables.



We still have the fridges available make us an offer.

CHANGES TO COVID ISOLATION RULES

As families, we now know the government has said that close contacts no longer need to self-isolate if they are testing negative to COVID. What this means for the staff & children of our service is we still want to minimise the risk of COVID being spread in our environment.

The details in the government announcement are that early childhood centres, pre-schools, schools & workplaces have to make their own decision if it is safe for close contacts to attend. If your child is a close contact please consider if he/she has to attend our service, ensure they are tested regularly for COVID, and inform educators of your current circumstances.

Please consider the impact on the whole community when making your decisions.

UPCOMING ACCESS TO SERVICE – REDUCING COVID RESTRICTIONS

Following up on the survey from the end of last term, the committee has agreed to gradually reduce the restriction on entering the service. This will be a slow and staged reduction of restrictions so that we can continually monitor the health and wellbeing of the staff and children.

Stage one. On completion of the building works to the Dapin Room we will allow one adult to enter the premises at pickup time. This will support the sharing of information regarding your child's day & viewing the activities that have occurred throughout their day.

Stage Two: Allowing one adult into the service to drop off and pick up their child.

Stage Three: No limits on adults entering the service.

Stage Four: No limits on people of all ages entering the service.

FREE FIRST AID TRAINING

Playgroup is offering a free First Aid training course for parents to attend on Wednesday the 25th of May. This course will run from 9:30AM to 3:00 PM. Please note there will be no childcare facilities. There are 10 positions available, and these will be offered to families who attend playgroup first. The remaining positions are open to families who have children attending our service. Positions will be offered first to those families who meet the TEI funding target groups or hold a low income health care card. If you are interested in taking up this free training opportunity please see or email your interest to Elizabeth. director@gloucesterpreschool.com.au

SUSTAINABILITY UPDATES

Did you know that an average Bic pen will draw a line about two to three kilometres long?

Did you know that one tree will make 25,000 pencils? The average pencil holds enough graphite to draw a line about 56 kilometres long.

The choice we can make is to use a pencil or a pen. Visualise this: the loss of 1 tree or a pile of ½ million pens that will take 500 years for the plastic to breakdown.

Considering this and the number of staff that use pens each day we have made the decision to only use a pen for official documents and for all other documentation we will use a pencil. Our service aims to make many small changes that will amount to a large impact on a positive future for our children.



INVESTIGATING SUSTAINABLE NAPPY CHOICES FOR FAMILIES



Following up on our survey regarding disposable nappies, we have been investigating giving families the choice of cloth nappies or a different brand of disposable nappies. The new products we will source will have a lower environmental footprint than the nappies we currently use.

We will update with more information very soon. If you have a child in nappies currently, please share your thoughts and ideas with the team, we want to generate more conversations on this and other sustainability topics.

VISION & PHILOSOPHY REVIEW

Thanks to all the families & staff that provided their feedback to this process. Below is the draft update which includes additional words & sentences to reflect our current environment, and the feedback received. Please let us know what you think, and any comments or additions, before we accept it as completed.

What is our vision?

To be a supportive, nurturing, inclusive educational service where children's wellbeing is promoted through natural play experiences. With families and the community, we strive to provide positive futures for our children.

Philosophy

At Gloucester Pre School & Early Years Learning Centre we view children as capable, competent co-contributors and active participants in their own learning. Early childhood education sets the foundation for positive lifelong learning.

Educators & staff actively strive to provide an environment and atmosphere in which children and families feel emotionally safe, secure, & a sense of belonging to our early years' education & care community.

Learning occurs in a supportive unhurried natural environment where children's individual perspectives, interests, backgrounds, families and life experiences are celebrated. Education is provided through:

Intentional teaching practices using children's interests.

Families' home cultural knowledge & experiences.

Knowledge & reconciliation with our local Aboriginal community, their beliefs & culture.

A respect of our environment & its resources.

These will be used to promote ongoing inquiry, knowledge and confidence in children's individual capabilities.

Educational practices are influenced by theorists like, Montessori, Dewey & Gardner through the lens of Claire Warden's Nature Pedagogy. Our service promotes a natural learning environment that includes learning beyond the boundary fence, connecting us to our rural community. We promote children to assess and take risks and build resilience in a supportive environment. We understand the connection that caring for our environment supports the long-term health and wellbeing of current and future generations of children. Our culture of organisational growth is based on critical reflection and ongoing professional learning.

Gloucester Pre-school strives to be an integral part of the local community. We collaborate and work in partnership with people, services, and agencies to develop shared understanding and actions that support children and families.

GLOUCESTER PRESCHOOL
MUM'S NIGHT OUT



**FRI
MAY
20TH**

**6PM
START**

DINNER & DANCING

COME JOIN US FOR A WELL DESERVED NIGHT OUT!

**AT THE FUNCTION ROOM, AVON VALLEY INN
TICKETS ARE \$25 AND INCLUDE DINNER, GAMES &
PRIZES**

RSVP & PAYMENT BY 17TH MAY

RSVP TO CHONTELLE ON 0437 329 440

PAYMENT CAN BE MADE IN CASH TO ROBYN

OR BANK TRANSFER: GLOUCESTER PRESCHOOL INC. BSB: 082 595 ACC: 50 967 8308